The Heart of the Ten Perfections

Daśapāramitāhṛdaya · Toh 937 · Derge Kangyur
ཕ་རོལ་ཏུ་ཕྱིན་པ་བཅུའི་སྙིང་པོ།

The Heart of the Ten Perfections, known in Tibetan as Pha rol tu phyin pa bcu'i snying po, is a very brief dhāraṇī, a short sacred formula meant to be recited or heard, whose Sanskrit title would correspond to something like the Daśapāramitāhṛdaya. It opens by promising that hearing this "heart" of the ten perfections even once will lead to attaining all ten perfections, the bodhisattva virtues that run from generosity through to wisdom. It then gives a single short mantra paying homage to all the tathāgatas who bring the ten perfections to completion, and it closes by naming itself the dhāraṇī for attaining the ten perfections. The work is Toh 937 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the collected dhāraṇī texts, the compact incantations valued for their protective and spiritually transformative power.

By hearing this heart of the ten perfections even once, one will attain the ten perfections.

namaḥ sarbatānāṃ tathāgatānāṃ daśapāramitāparipūrakānāṃ hāṃ

The dhāraṇī for attaining the ten perfections is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The final syllable of the colophon is written "sho" where the usual closing is "so" (as in "it is complete"). It has been read as that ordinary closing particle.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.